

Present simple and adverbs of frequency

Use

We use the present simple:

- to talk about habits and routines.
*I **play tennis** every week.*
- to talk about things that are always true.
*Sleep **is** really important for health.*

Form

We form the present simple with the infinitive form of the verb. To make negative sentences, we add *don't* before the verb. To make questions, we add *do* before the subject.

After *he, she, it*, etc. we add *-s* to the verb. We use *doesn't* in negative sentences, and *does* in questions.

	+	-	?
I/you/we/they	<i>I eat.</i>	<i>You don't eat.</i>	<i>Do you eat?</i>
he/she/it	<i>She eats.</i>	<i>He doesn't eat.</i>	<i>Does he/she/it eat?</i>

The verb *be* is different from other verbs.

	+	-	?
I	<i>I'm fit.</i>	<i>I'm not fit.</i>	<i>Am I fit?</i>
you/we/they	<i>We're fit.</i>	<i>They aren't fit.</i>	<i>Are you fit?</i>
he/she/it	<i>She's fit.</i>	<i>She isn't fit.</i>	<i>Is he fit?</i>

Adverbs and expressions of frequency

We use adverbs and other expressions in present simple sentences to talk about how often we do things.

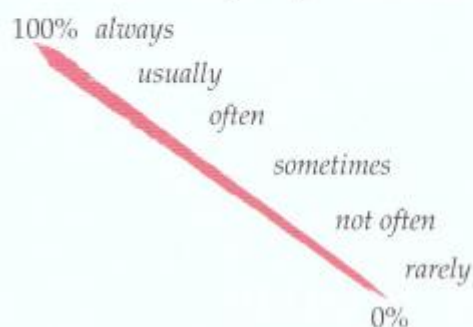
Mike **usually** goes for a run in the evening.

I'm **often** late for work.

I have a hot drink **five or six times a day**.

We go on holiday **two or three times a year**.

Some common frequency adverbs are:



Position

Frequency adverbs and expressions of frequency go in different places in a sentence.

- Adverbs of frequency go before the main verb, but after the verb *to be*.

*They **never** eat out.*

*She's **always** out at the weekend.*

*I **don't** **often** do sport.*

- Expressions of frequency normally go at the beginning or end of a sentence.

*I go out with friends **three or four times a week**.*

***Once a week**, I go for a run.*

Exercises

- 1** Complete the sentences with the present simple form of the verbs in brackets.

1 Sam _____ (not live) near me.

2 Sofia _____ (drive) to work.

3 _____ she _____ (speak) any other languages?

4 I _____ (not like) waking up early.

5 _____ they _____ (see) each other at the weekends?

6 We _____ (be) very tired.

7 Some people _____ (not need) a lot of sleep.

8 _____ (be) your bus late?

9 He _____ (have) a big house in the country.

- 2** Look at the sentences. There are five mistakes with the position of frequency adverbs and time expressions. Find and correct the mistakes.

1 I often am tired at work.

2 We twice a week eat out in a restaurant.

3 Do you often check your phone for messages?

4 She is never late to my lesson.

5 I have two or three times a day a cup of coffee.

6 They don't play often board games.

7 Does usually she take public transport?

- 3 Complete the text with words from the boxes. Use a verb from box A or a phrase from box B in each gap. You do not need all the words in the boxes.

A always every day never often rarely
two or three times a month usually

B eat get up go have leave make
meet

I ¹ _____ ² _____ at about 7.30 a.m.
and get ready for work. I ³ _____
⁴ _____ breakfast because I don't feel hungry
in the mornings. I start work at 9 a.m. and at 12
I have a lunch break. I ⁵ _____ ⁶ _____
my friend for lunch – normally two or three times
a week. At 1.30 I start work again and finish at
5.30 p.m. I like to keep fit, so I ⁷ _____ to the
gym ⁸ _____. I get home at about
8.00 p.m. and make dinner, but I also ⁹ _____
at restaurants ¹⁰ _____. I'm always tired in
the evenings so I go to bed early. And that's my
day!